

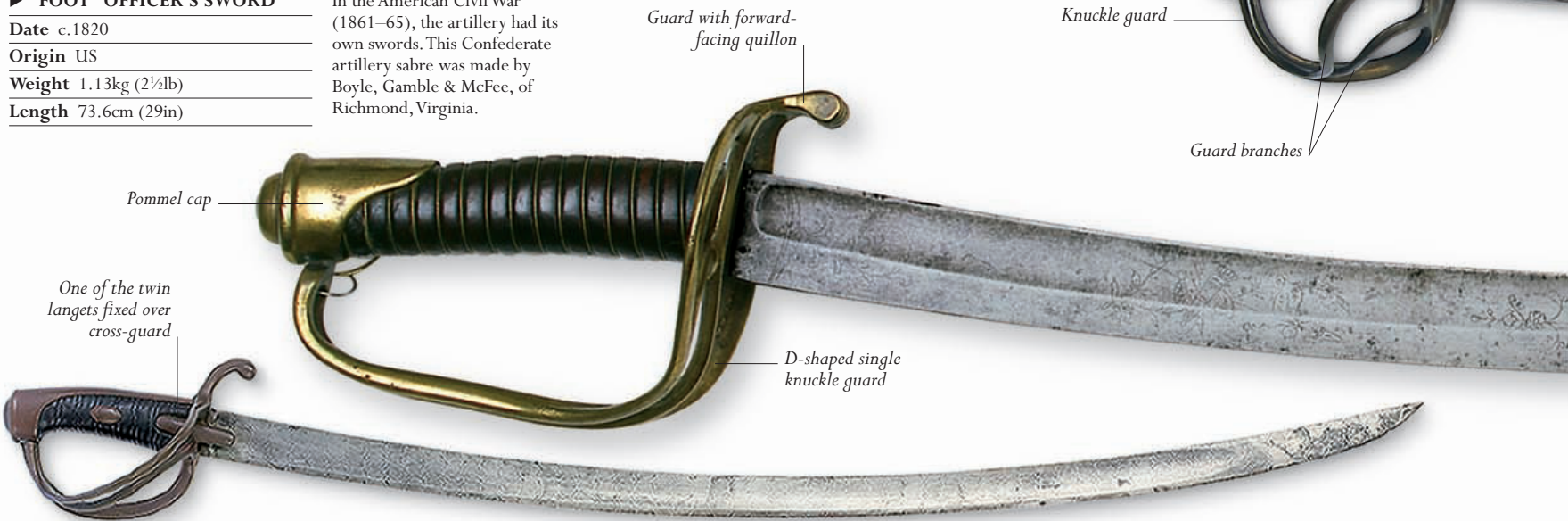
INFANTRY AND CAVALRY SWORDS AND BAYONETS

By 1815, infantry swords were becoming little more than ceremonial weapons, although officers and senior NCOs continued to carry them as symbols of rank. The design of these swords was increasingly decorative. In the course of the 19th century, the sword bayonet replaced the infantryman’s socket bayonet and hanger sword. The rise of long-range firearms meant that the bayonet was of little use in combat, but infantrymen were still equipped with it because armies believed the weapon fostered an aggressive spirit. In these years, light cavalry used a curved sabre designed for slicing and cutting, while heavy cavalry carried a thrusting sword with a long, straight blade.

► “FOOT” OFFICER’S SWORD

Date	c.1820
Origin	US
Weight	1.13kg (2½lb)
Length	73.6cm (29in)

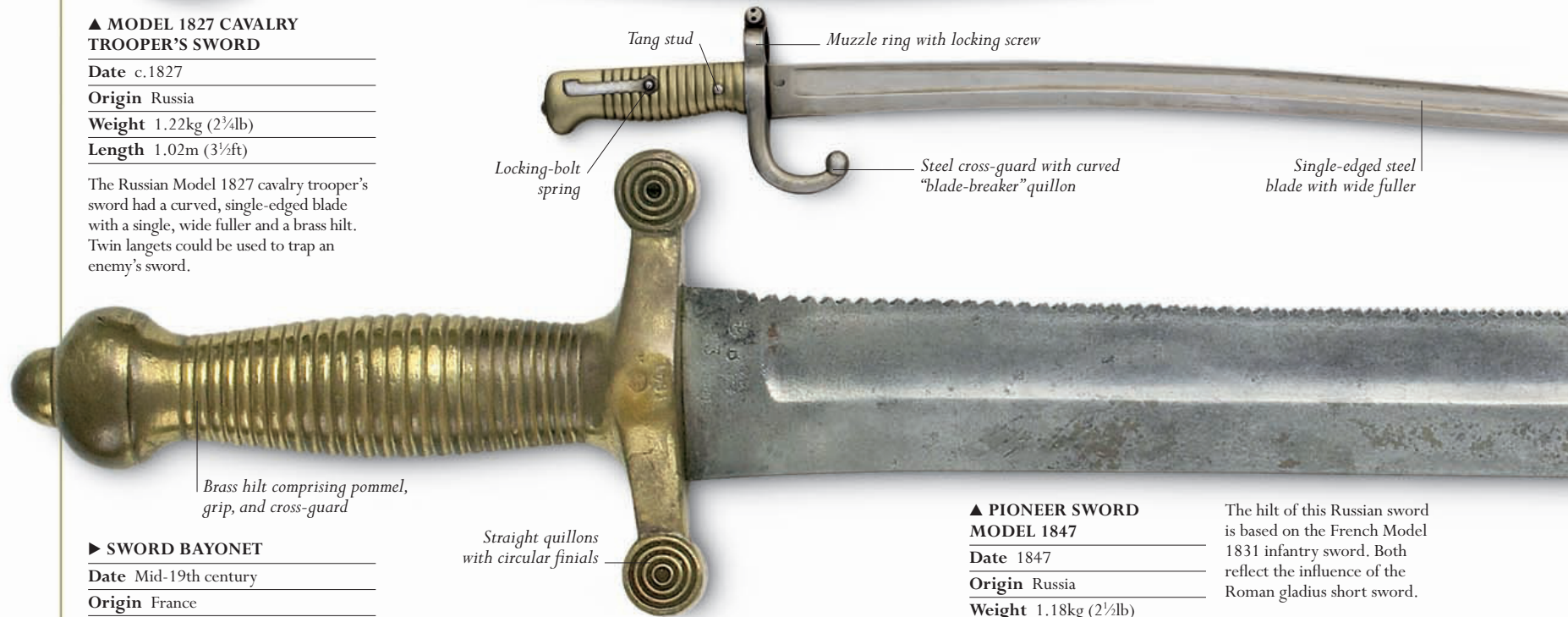
In the American Civil War (1861–65), the artillery had its own swords. This Confederate artillery sabre was made by Boyle, Gamble & McFee, of Richmond, Virginia.



▲ MODEL 1827 CAVALRY TROOPER’S SWORD

Date	c.1827
Origin	Russia
Weight	1.22kg (2¾lb)
Length	1.02m (3½ft)

The Russian Model 1827 cavalry trooper’s sword had a curved, single-edged blade with a single, wide fuller and a brass hilt. Twin langets could be used to trap an enemy’s sword.



► SWORD BAYONET

Date	Mid-19th century
Origin	France
Weight	790g (27¼oz)
Length	1.15m (3¾ft)

This French sword bayonet, with a long, narrow blade, is unusual in having a basket hilt – a feature usually associated with a cavalry sword.



▲ INFANTRY HANGER SWORD

Date	c.1760–1820
Origin	UK
Weight	840g (29½oz)
Length	79.7cm (31¼in)

The hanger sword traditionally carried by the infantry was a crude military variant of a short hunting sword, almost always with a straight or slightly curved blade.

